



JB Park
CEO and President,
Samsung Southwest Asia

AI needs screens

Samsung's JB Park on why hardware will continue to stay crucial

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We are witnessing a rapid rise of AI platforms and large language models. Almost all major OEMs have entered into partnerships with AI companies, putting several LLM models at the heart of your smartphone or PC experience. This leads to the question whether software and AI companies will dominate the next wave of technology. Even in the age of AI, hardware will remain indispensable, believes JB Park, CEO and President, Samsung Southwest Asia

Samsung's Galaxy ecosystem already integrates multiple AI partners, including tools powered by Google Gemini and Perplexity AI. Yet Park believes the relationship between AI companies and hardware makers is inherently symbiotic.

"AI output still needs a screen," he said, on the sidelines of the recently concluded Galaxy Unpacked event.

"Whether it's a report, a video, or information generated by an AI assistant, it has to be displayed somewhere for the user to understand."

From smartphones to televisions, hardware devices remain the gateway through which consumers interact with AI content. Until futuristic technologies such as brain-embedded chips become viable, Park says, hardware brands will continue to play a central role in shaping AI experiences.

He said that while the consumer mindset is changing, the transition will take time, especially in a diverse and value-conscious market like India. While addressing the larger group of journalists, Park outlined how Samsung is trying to reposition AI not just as a feature, but as an ecosystem benefit that enhances life across devices.

Park acknowledged that Indian consumers largely evaluate products through specs and price comparisons.

"When a consumer goes to buy a device, they often look at the display size, battery, or the cheapest price available across channels," he said. "But beyond that, AI functionality can significantly improve lifestyle. Our job is to communicate that value."

Park believes that once consumers experience the convenience of connected AI services such as automation, cross-device control, and personalised recommendations -- the technology will become a stronger purchase driver. However, he admits that "not 100% of Indian consumers understand the value yet," making awareness and education a focus area for them.

Park pointed out that Samsung's innovation stems from its unique position as both a consumer electronics brand and a component manufacturer. The company produces critical tech including displays, memory, processors, and batteries that power devices across the industry.

"Many competitors are using Samsung components in their products," he noted. "The innovation comes from understanding consumer pain points and developing techn to solve them."

One such example is Samsung's early bet on foldable smartphones. As screens grew larger and devices became harder to carry, the company envisioned a foldable form factor that could deliver a bigger display without compromising portability. This philosophy continues to guide experimentation with new form factors. Park cited devices such as the Samsung Galaxy Z TriFold, which combined tablet-sized screens with pocketable portability.

India is playing a bigger role in Samsung's global innovation pipeline. Park pointed to the company's R&D operations in Bengaluru, where teams are developing algorithms for on-device AI capabilities for camera intelligence.

Samsung announced its new lineup of Galaxy phones with several AI-focused features and experiences. 